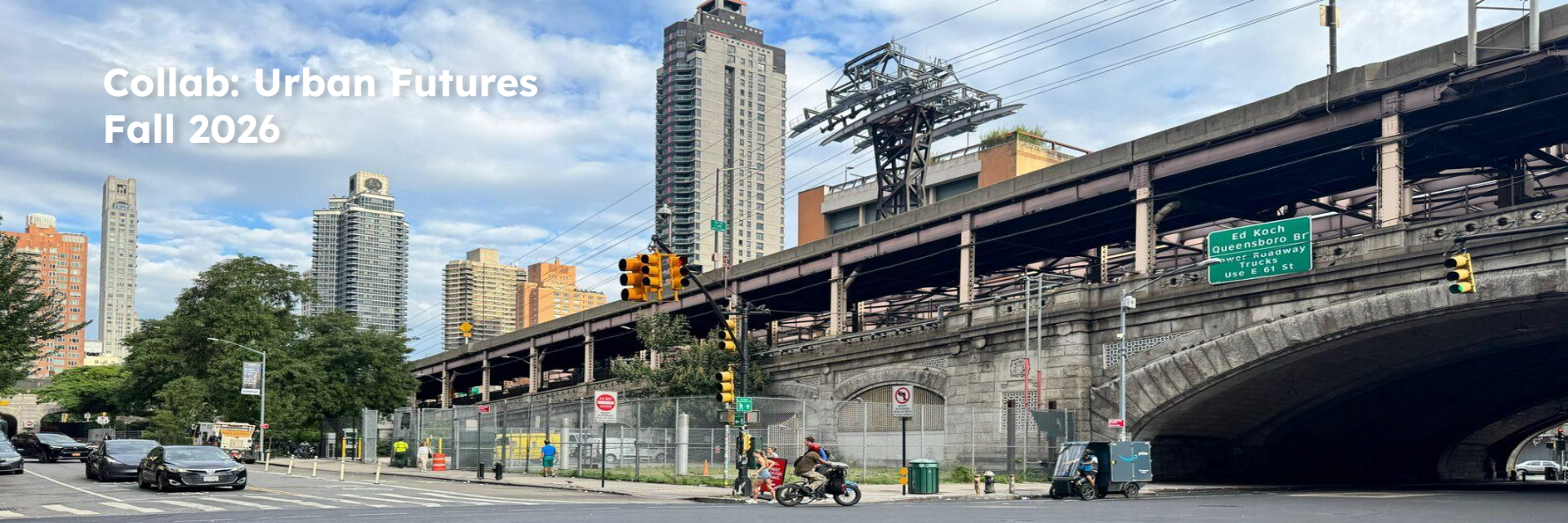
Collab: Urban Futures
Fall 2026



XR Urban Futures
Midterm Presentation
RED TEAM

Site Location: 1st Ave & E 60th St

XR Urban Futures Midterm Presentation
Red Team Introduction

Yen Jung Chen

MPS Communication Design
First Year Student

- Graphic Design
- Web Page Design
- Storytelling
- Narratives

Zhuoqiao Liu (Jerry Liu)

MFA Design and Technology
Second Year Student

- Computer Arts
- Game Design
- Unity Engine
- Unreal Engine 5
- Environment Design

Kenny Luong

MFA Design and Technology
Second Year Student

- Computer Science
- Unity Engine
- 3D Space Building

Natasha Mboya

MFA Design and Technology
Second Year Student

- Computer Science
- Blender 3D

Valentine Ye

MFA Design and Technology
Second Year Student

- Additive Making
- Physical Computing
- Autodesk Fusion 360

The Overview of the Site

- **A vacant grassy area** on the north side of the Queensboro Bridge approach, between the bridge wall and E 60th St
- **Adjacent to 1st Ave**, where numerous trucks enter and exit the bridge at this corner.
- **Neighboring:** an existing hexagonal pocket park path along the bridge wall with benches and planting.
- **Currently inaccessible to the public, fenced and unprogrammed.**






Ed Koch Queensboro Bridge Path
Ed Koch Queensboro Bridge Lower Roadway
Ed Koch Queensboro Bridge Upper Roadway
64.95 ft
106.41 ft
Design site B
22.03 ft
Honey
Locust Park
345
Parking lot
(Not in scope)
50.3 ft
Design site A
54.4 ft
E 59th St
Say Coffee
Wave59
夜總會
N
25

Community Voices








By gathering different perspectives, we aimed to identify real community needs and explore design opportunities that could make the space more accessible, functional, and welcoming.

Many dog walkers and runners pass through this area, but the current site is less of a destination and more of a liminal area.

Interview themes

The strongest signals: the space feels empty, there is nowhere to sit, and people want food nearby.

Theme	Raised by
Empty area with no function	#2, #3, #4
Not enough seating	#2, #3, #4
Want food / coffee / stands	#2, #3
Not enough light at night	#2, #3
Noise, garbage trucks, rats	#2
Values the trees and existing social life	#1
Many dog walkers; nearest dog park inconvenient	#2
Many families, kids and schools nearby	#2, #4

Post-Interview Design Opportunities





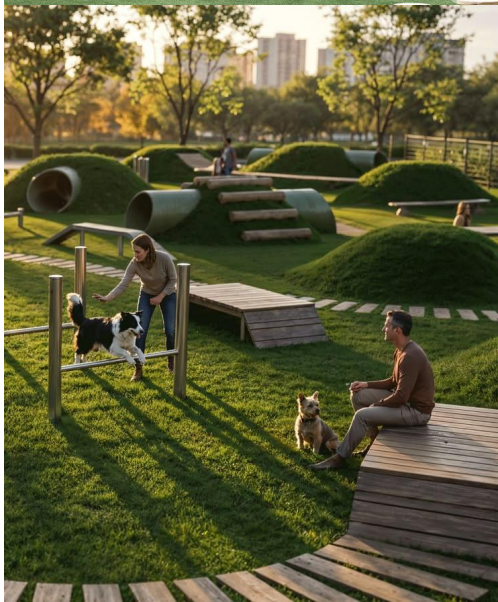


- Add comfortable seating and **shaded areas.**
- Introduce **food trucks, coffee carts, and small vendors.**
- Create flexible spaces for community activities and social gatherings.
- Improve **nighttime lighting** and waste management.
- Provide both **family** and **dog-friendly** facilities.
- Preserve existing trees and **encourage social interaction.**

Design site A: DOG PARK

A **dog park** situated at the corner of the intersection for dog owners **to rest and allow their canine companions to roam** around in a **fenced enclosure.**
Due to the site's size, many structures will need to take advantage of **verticality.**





Features Include:

- A **slide** for both **dogs** and **children**
- A large **folly structur**e at the center of the park
- *Removable* **tunnel mounds** themed to Hobbit holes
- **Benches** and human/dog **water fountains**
- **Double gated entrance** to prevent runaways
- **Wall-mounted ramps** in the style of hamster tunnels

Research: Dog Run Precedents (NYC)

Design site A

Washington Square Park Dog Run:

- ~5,000 SF split into small-dog (<20 lbs) and large-dog zones; gravel floor for drainage, shaded seating, seasonal water

Tribeca Dog Run: 4,000 SF public run

Jemmy's Dog Run, Madison Square Park:

- Double entry/exit gates, dedicated large & small areas, joint-friendly ground material, upgraded lighting and water

Trust for Public Land 'Dog Parks 101' (2019):

- Separate small/large areas listed as a core design element; typical kit = 4–6 ft fence, double gates, drainage, benches, shade, water



Dog fountain (GymsForDogs)

Dog Park Design Research

Design site A

We evaluated our proposed design against established dog park guidelines to inform and refine our design decisions.

Element	Research finding	Current proposal
Size	Enough room to run while allowing owners to supervise the whole space	Entire fenced corner lawn
Play structures	Agility features provide opportunities for activity	Running pipes, slide, folly structure, and mounds
Seating	Seats should face the run for supervision	Benches along the west edge
Water	Drinking-water stations support dogs during play	Two stations: northwest and southwest

What We Heard → Design Response

Design site A

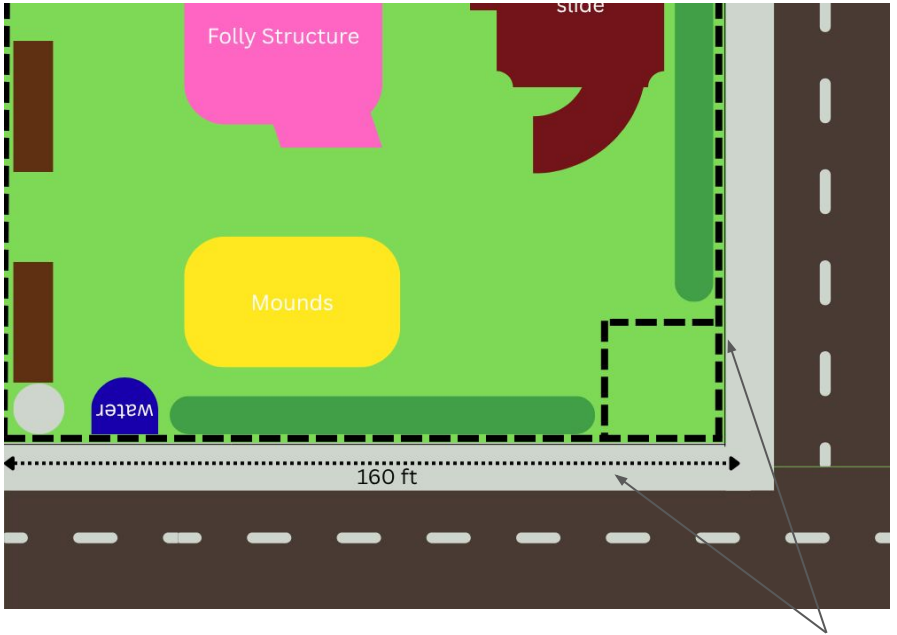
What we heard	Design response
Only one seat, nowhere to sit (3 of 4)	Runner rest + owner seating edge
Noise, garbage trucks, gas smell	Evergreen planting buffer on street and fence lines
Too dark; rats in the planting at night	Night lighting; low, open planting inside the runs
Nearest dog run is far and icy in winter	Dog park on this site, cleared of snow and ice year-round
Many families and kids walk by	Double-gated entries mid-block, away from the 1st Ave corner
Values the trees and the people here	Keep existing trees; seating open to everyone

Source: Red Team intercept interviews

Enclosure & Entry

Design site A

- **Fence: The recommended size is 4–6 ft (Dallas Guidelines). We propose a 6ft fence along both street sides.**
- **Entry: Double-gated entry: two gates 8–12 ft apart, each at least 4 ft wide; ADA minimum 36 in (Wagbar). We propose a gated corner area**
- **Dog separation: Separate areas for large and small dogs are now the standard (CB5). The current proposal has one shared area.**



Next Steps: Entrance dimensions and shared vs. separate dog areas.

Plants & Landscaping

Design site A

Research findings:

- Synthetic dog turf and permeable pavers are recommended for drainage and cleaning (CB5, Unilock)
- Surface selection needs to account for maintenance

Current proposal:

- Lawn with planting strips
- Trees at corners; planting along east and south edges



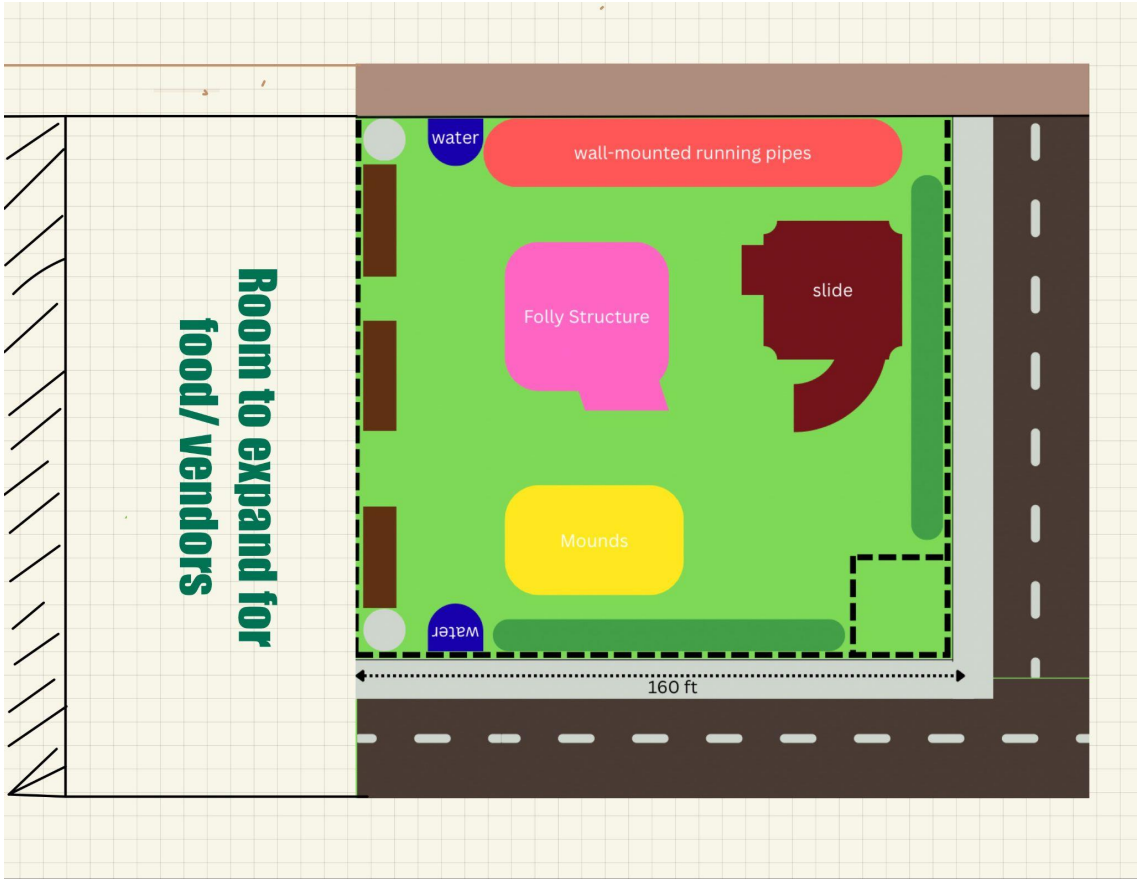
Next steps: Evaluate the proposed lawn against drainage, cleaning, and wear requirements.

Interview Considerations

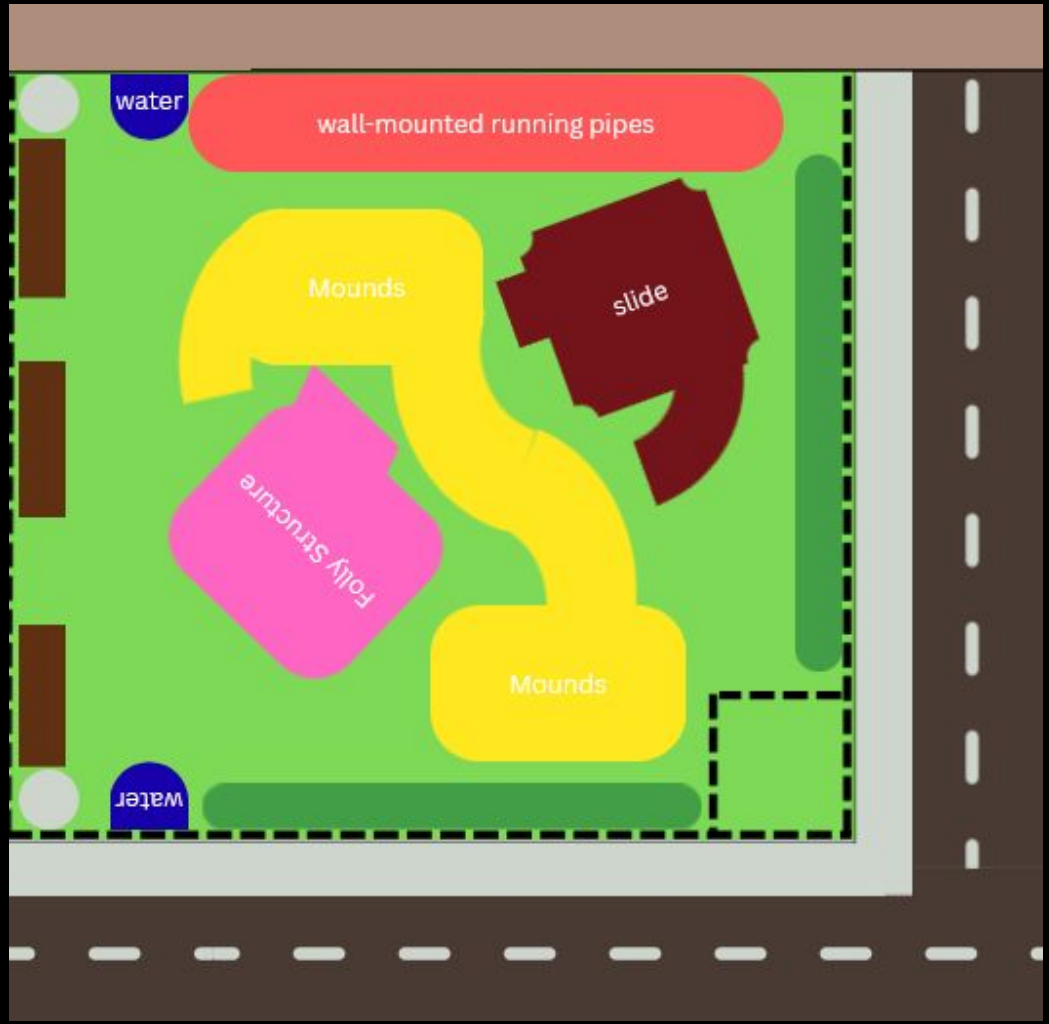
Design site A

- Café kiosk + movable seating: interviewees #2, #3 and #4 asked for food and more seats. A park kiosk model exists (Bryant Park Kiosks RFP), but alcohol needs a State Liquor Authority license.

- Darts area and a small skate practice strip (interviewee #2).



Design site A



Age Demographics

Our five user scenarios span ages 12 to 80: the park has to work for every generation.

12	23	28	53	80
Jason	**Stephanie**	**Timothy**	**Richard**	**Carrie**
Kid · German shepherd	Runner · senior pitbull	Young adult · corgi + pug	Evening walker · labrador	Senior · French bulldog

Who we heard from

- Students who pass by daily on the way to school
- Families with kids walking to school in the morning
- Local residents and nearby workers
- Dog walkers and runners passing through

What this means for design

- Kids: gated entries away from the 1st Ave corner; slide sized for small children
- Seniors: benches facing the run, even surfacing, brighter night lighting
- Everyone: seating open to all, not only dog owners

User Scenarios (Part I)

Design site A



Scenario 1: Richard (Age 53): Owns an 11-year old labrador retriever (75 pounds).

Richard walks his dog every evening at 7 PM. With the sky going dark much earlier, he is looking for a safe place to sit and rest for five minutes with his dog leashed in hand before continuing his walk. He enters the dog park and sits on a bench alongside his dog for a while, before both of them grab a drink at a water fountain and leave to continue their walk.



Scenario 2: Jason (Age 12): owns a 2-year-old German shepherd (60 pounds)

Jason and his energetic dog Ace enter the park looking to run around and play. Due to his size, Ace is unable to climb up the wall-mounted structure or fit inside the mounds. He instead runs circles around the enclosed area, zigzagging between the mounds and showing some mild interest in—but ultimately not interacting with—the folly. Jason follows his dog in running around the area but mainly uses the slide in the corner of the park for fun.

User Scenarios (Part II)

Design site A



Scenario 3: Timothy (Age 28): owns two dogs: a 5-year-old corgi, and a 3-year-old pug

Timothy brings his two sociable dogs to the park to get them to engage with other dogs in the neighborhood. Unfortunately, he arrives on a busy Saturday and must stand due to the benches being full. His corgi mainly runs around in the hobbit hole mounds and up and down the wall-mounted pipes while his pug prefers to go up and down the slide.



Scenario 4: Stephanie (Age 23): owns a 12-year-old pitbull (50 pounds)

Stephanie brings her elderly pitbull to the park to get a drink of water after a daily run. She only stops there momentarily to rest and unleashes her dog. Her dog, preferring the company of humans, snuggles up to her at the bench instead of interacting with the other structures and cautiously walks around. The pair leave after spending ten minutes at the park.



Scenario 5: Carrie (Age 80): owns a 8-month-old French bulldog

Carrie is walking near the Queensboro Bridge in the early morning and comes across the dog park. After having a drink and sitting down, she unleashes her young puppy, who begins sprinting around the area, speeding through each tunnel mound. After five minutes of sprinting, her dog gets tired and falls asleep in the dirt near a tree.

Design site A





















Design site A

Red Team Dog Park Demo

Interactive 3D Space of Site Design







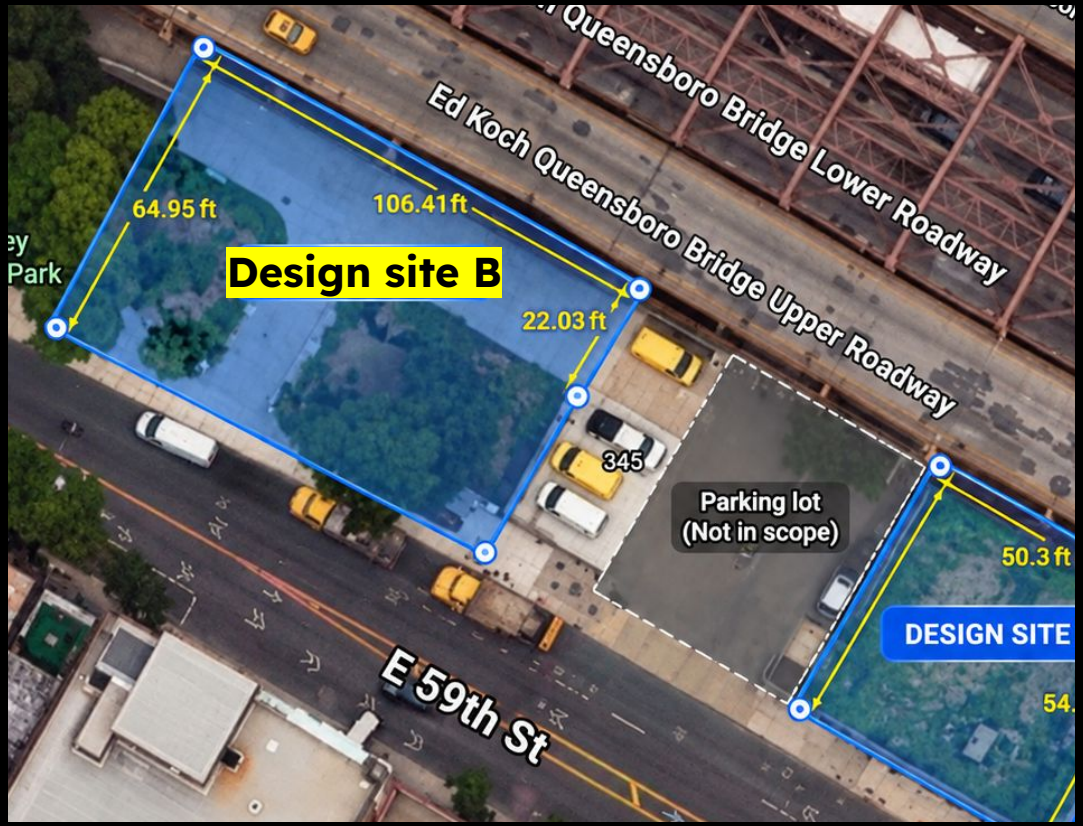
Red Team Dog Park Demo for Site A

Interactive 3D Space of Site Design (Uploaded to GitHub)

- Walk around with WASD keys
- Control view range with mouse hover
- Jump with Space key

https://collab-urban-futures-fall-2026.github.io/Red-Team-Dog-Park-Demo-1/Experimental%20Dog%20Park%20Demo.html

Design site B

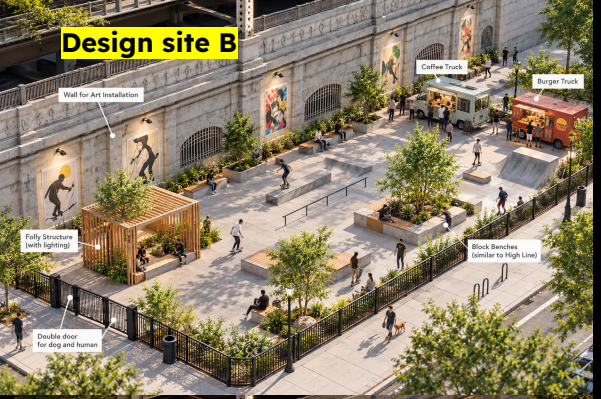


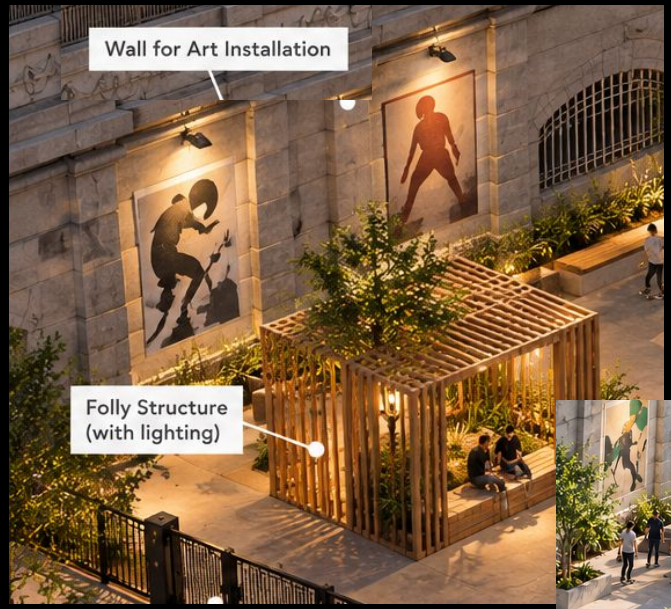
For **Site B**, we realized that it's actually an underused extension of the existing park.

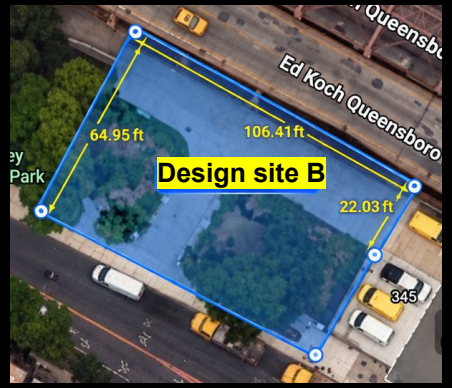
Based on our **interviews** with local people, we plan to add more features to make the space more inviting and functional.

For example, we want to introduce **food trucks**, change the ground surface to make it suitable for **skateboarding**, and add **artwork** along the **bridge** wall or invite local artists to create art here.

We also plan to add more **lighting** and **seating** to make people feel safer and more comfortable hanging out in this space.

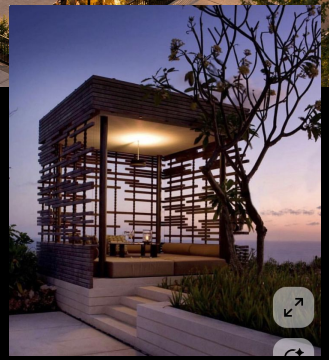






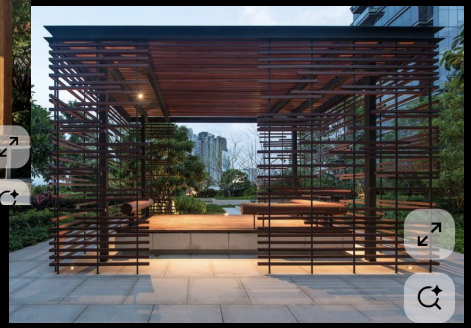












Folly References

Red Team Dog Park Demo for Site B



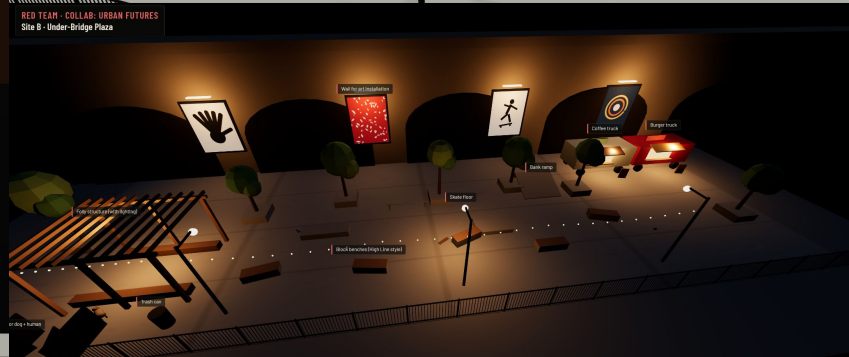
Interactive 3D Space of Site Design Section B

[Experience by clicking this link]

- Walk around with WASD keys + arrow keys
- Control view range with mouse hover
- Jump with Space key







Thank You!